

Thursday, October 15

Peter was riding his bike when I came home, and Cheryl was in the kitchen feeding Matthew. He called to me, and I sat with them at the table. I spoke about Kindrachuk's (the Education Director) visit to my school. Peter showed up and was leaning across the table for some rice and broccoli.

I said, to Cheryl, 'Kindrachuk didn't look very well. He seemed grey and pale and ...'

'Dowdy,' interrupted Peter.

It's not rare for Peter to intrude on conversations that are none of his business.

I went to the bank after supper. I read the last of Tuck Everlasting while Peter lay on the floor. He mourned aloud Winnie's death. Cheryl read Robin Hood to him. Matthew, having slept only a half hour today, was asleep by 7.

An insurance agent came at 7:30. She talked about the range of options. We purchased the cheapest term policy. She was clearly unhappy. Peter sat on my lap, trying to lie down while she filled out the forms. After she left I practised guitar.

Peter had been sleeping awhile when he woke up in tears. He told Cheryl monsters were threatening to eat us and his little baby brother.

I got a call from someone at the Mayor's office and was asked about the size of our family. I asked who this really was. Then the boy's voice broke. 'Oh Mr. Hedlin,' it sobbed, 'it's Derek. I'd better explain tomorrow.'

Matthew's teeth are bothering him. Cheryl and I went to bed at 10:15, tired out by Matthew's 6 am risings.

Cheryl had planned to go with Peter to a symphony concert this afternoon, but Matthew was sick so the plans were cancelled. She read knitting magazines while he sat on her knee, then walked around the house with a bowl on his head and pots in his hand.

Peter wants to begin to write. He has Cheryl to write things he can copy.

The boys are very affectionate with each other. They're either hugging, or Matthew piles on Peter and they lie quietly for a moment.

I played badminton at school and broke my 'a' nail. This is a much ridiculed (by Cheryl) classical guitar term. Later, Peter was in the bathroom for some time before Cheryl called, asking him what he was up to. He said, 'I'm making my nails stronger.' She found him applying my nail hardener.

I watched baseball awhile, then read *The Borrowers* to Peter. Cheryl read the paper and played with Matthew. Peter ran back and forth in the hallway. We briefly thought of going out for ice-cream, but it's Friday and we're so tired we wouldn't have beat out a fire if it was in our lap.